

Project 4

Course Code and Name: GEF1202 Advance English Writing Skills

Project Name: Islamophobia in Western Societies & Drug Trafficking in Bangladesh

Project Type: English Feature Writing

Date of Submission: Fall 2022

Project Description:

This project consists of two pieces of persuasive writing produced for Advanced English Writing Skills: an opinion article examining Islamophobia in Western societies, and an editorial addressing the problem of drug trafficking in Bangladesh. Both pieces apply feature/opinion writing conventions to real, socially relevant issues rather than a single narrative subject.

Project Justification:

This course focuses on advanced English writing skills, particularly feature and opinion writing. I chose to write on Islamophobia and on drug trafficking because both are current, socially significant issues that let me practice persuasive structure, evidence-based argument, and an engaging journalistic voice, showcasing the writing skills the course targets.



ULAB

UNIVERSITY OF LIBERAL ARTS BANGLADESH

Department of Media Studies and Journalism

University of Liberal Arts Bangladesh

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MSJ 11201/GEF 1202: English for Media/Advanced

English Writing Skills (Sec 02)

Student Name	Showmiq Islam Utshow
Student ID	221012042
Course Code	GEF 1202
Course Title	Advanced English Writing
Session	Fall

Islamophobia among Western Societies

Despite disagreement about the term, its origins, and its effects, there is general agreement that Islamophobia exists in many western nations today and that acts of abuse and violence against Muslims and Muslims in particular constitute a violation of human rights. Those who are still unsure about the phrase identify it only with an emotional condition characterized by dread and hatred, directed against Muslim populations residing in the West, with the exception of a minority position that fully rejects the usage of the term. They assert that people who like to use the term "Islamophobia" only do so in order to defend the Islamic faith against criticism, and they deny that there is any hatred aimed towards Islam as a whole. Some believe it to be a recent occurrence brought on by Muslims' failure to assimilate into the Western countries in which they reside or by members of militant organizations, whose behavior raises suspicion and terror. The majority of researchers who have examined the phenomena agree that it has a long history and a variety of causes, the bulk of which are those who have committed abuse or assault.

Moreover, participants expressed concern that talks on gender equality were frequently limited to topics like forced marriages, honor murders, head scarves, and other forms of attire, neglecting prejudice that occurs on a daily basis, including in the workplace (gender equality). It was said that Muslim women were frequently politicized to amplify disparities between Muslims and non-Muslims, but that this politicization frequently failed to take into account the needs and reality of Muslim women.

Furthermore, it was considered how to reconcile the protection of free expression with the needs of weaker organizations and people. Despite appeals for defamation of religion laws, it was widely agreed that the best course of action was publicly denouncing intolerable speech and not passing laws to prevent it. As a way to best combat hate speech, self-regulation, codes of behavior, internet monitoring, and training for the media and other sectors of society, including the constructive engagement of political leaders (hate speech).

The most biased groups or individuals when it comes to discrimination from public services and the authorities are police and other law enforcement agents. Government employees are ranked second, followed by educators and teachers. The Universal Declaration of Human Rights forbids discrimination against minority populations and based on religion. This study aims to look at the

relationship between anti-Muslim or anti-Arab sentiment among the Arab or Islamic community, hate crime statistics, and anti-Muslim speech on social media.

Conclusively, the majority of portrayals of Muslims in Western mainstream media tend to be unfavorable, despite some attempts to present fair and impartial representations of Muslims. In reality, despite the fact that many diverse information sources contribute to unfavorable public attitudes about Muslims, many researchers contend that the media is the most important. Perceptions of one another in connection to media representations and political policies are discussed in literature on the interactions between Western and Muslim communities.

Editorial Writing:

Drug Trafficking in Bangladesh

Drug misuse has a significant impact on a nation's societal and economic features. It is a rising problem in Bangladesh, where the majority of those affected are young adults, ranging in age from 18 to 30, and who belong from all social classes. Several epidemiological studies conducted in Bangladesh indicate that due to the sharp rise in drug addicts, the nation would eventually become a possible drug consumer. Illegal drug transportation needs to be swiftly controlled for the protection of our people and society from this deadly game.

Bangladesh is a country that is encircled by India on three sides. Hills and mountains encircle both the northern and eastern borders. Additionally, most of the western portion is plain ground. The hilly areas are ideal for trafficking in illegal drugs. In these hilly forests, the traffickers may simply conceal themselves while moving the drugs without having been caught. There are numerous border crossing locations in Bangladesh, where millions of dollars in cash are daily swapped for drugs.

However, even inside a given jurisdiction, a substance's classification may be debatable or unknown with regard to whether or not it should be classed as a drug and how, if at all. As there are several meanings in drug control law, governmental regulations, medical, and everyday usage, there is no single, clear definition.

Bangladesh's increased drug use, notably young people making up the majority, has made it a very unsafe place for environmental sustainability. Anti-drug issues are therefore a major obstacle to Bangladesh's improvement. The stakeholders in the nation should take quick action to end drug usage and addiction in order to assure a better and new generation.

Clearly, Bangladesh's health, education, social, and law enforcement sectors must work together to reduce drug abuse, lower demand, and illegal trafficking. Any anti-drug policy with rational, evidence-based responses that foster confidence in the ability of the State to enforce the law must start with concern for rights and the rule of justice as its core tenet. Schools must have outreach programs for kids and teens as well as educated media campaigns. Additionally, governments must make sure that no one is excluded or subjected to discrimination. Because people use drugs, people do not forfeit their social justice or dignity. Equal rights to health, life, non-discrimination, and independence against arbitrary arrest and detention are all guaranteed to them.

Our citizens of Bangladesh need drug-free lives and drug laws that safeguard their fundamental rights. This is crucial to ensuring that children and teenagers continue to experience violence-free and to benefit from the rights to education, health, and information. It really is essential for governments, citizens, civil society, and the UN to work together to combat the problem with drugs and support the development of a drug-free generation.

Learning and outcomes:

- Learned to look at social problems from different perspectives rather than focusing on only one side.
- Improved their ability to research, organize, and analyze information before presenting an argument.
- Gained an understanding of how social problems require collective action from governments, media, communities, and individuals.
- Improved critical thinking and analytical writing skills by discussing the causes, effects, and possible solutions to complex issues.
- Developed stronger editorial and argumentative writing skills, especially in presenting opinions with supporting explanations.